

HDTVs

The difference between Sony and Samsung, based on responses for certain questions under credibility and satisfaction, was often less than 1%

Laptops/Netbooks

In terms of innovation, Sony edged out Apple in the results, and when it came to ease of use HP was the chosen one

Laptops and Netbooks

Everywhere you go

The results saw Dell emerge as the eventual winner ahead of HP and Sony. What's commendable is that Dell gained four ranks from last year to capture the top spot, while last year's winner Lenovo fell to fourth. Last year, HP and Sony were tied for second, and this year HP stays at second, inching ahead of Sony.

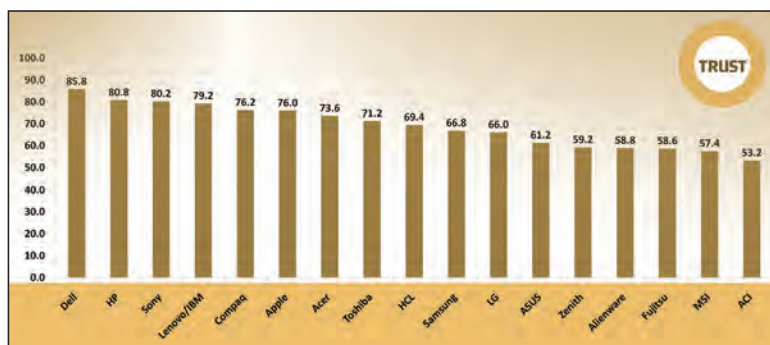
Last year we had a three-way tie for seventh between Fujitsu, Zenith and LG. This year, these three fell the most in the rankings – Fujitsu fell eight places, Zenith fell by six, and LG dropped four spots. We also had four new entrants this year – ASUS, Alienware, ACI and MSI. ASUS debuted straight into twelfth place, which is a big jump in such a crowded space of seventeen players.

When it comes to awareness, Dell and HP dominated in terms of top of mind, unaided recall. The other brands that people were able to recall easily, without help, were Lenovo and Sony. When it came to aided recall, everyone seemed to suddenly

remember that Compaq still makes laptops – jumping it to second spot in a tie with HP.

Apple jumped into the fray with a rather high credibility amongst the respondents, who felt that they could trust the quality of Apple's notebooks the most. Sony was second in that regard. The responses also indicated that Dell made the sturdiest products, while Dell and Lenovo, in that order, were listed as the brands that listened to consumer needs the best. People also felt that Apple's products were the most advanced, but just a tad more than Dell's. When it came to style, Apple won, with Sony close behind.

When we quizzed the respondents about satisfaction, Dell, HP and Sony emerged as the top three. HP was recognised as the brand most easily available all over India, and also had the most models available on demand. Respondents also felt that Dell



I've been using laptops for over five years and Apple is the best one I've used in my life.

Durgapur, Shyamson Goswami

I use Zenith and I like it very much. I would rate it higher than an HP or Sony of the same price.

Charu Peer, Mumbai

had the best after sales service, responded to queries better, and had the quickest turnaround when repairing faulty products.

When it came to loyalty, more people spoke positively about Sony to their friends, and more also said they would recommend Sony as a purchase to friends. Dell owners seem to be a satisfied bunch, and Dell was the answer when we asked people if they would continue to use the same brand.

For TCO, however, Sony, Apple and Alienware were

thought of as too expensive, and fell to the bottom of the ranking. Dell, Compaq and Acer were considered the cheapest in terms of purchase and maintenance. HP came fourth in that same list, and lost a lot of points in the overall running.

In the end, Dell dominated every aspect of our trust calculation. We do expect a major scrap in this segment, so we hope to see the top five chop and change ranks over the course of the year until our next survey.

PMPs

Rock the vote

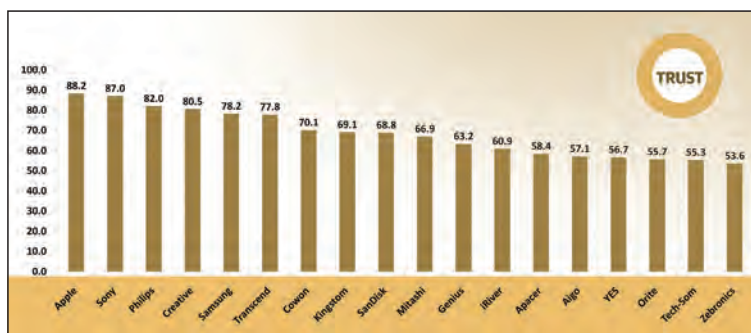
Last year's results saw Sony at the top, with Apple quite a bit behind. This year, however, Apple's fought back to claim the top spot, with Sony very close on its heels. Apple won on overall, despite Sony winning in three of the five parameters. So how exactly did this happen?

The answer lies in the awareness factor. Despite contributing the least weight to the overall score, Apple kept up with Sony on all counts, but trounced the entire list of brands here when it came to awareness. Consider this, over 60 per cent of all people polled said "Apple" when they were asked to name the first PMP brand that came to mind. In comparison, only six per cent of people said "Sony".

Credibility saw Sony take top spot, and Apple was a close second with Philips, Creative and Samsung following. When it came to quality of the products, Sony edged ahead of Apple, and remained there when we asked about sturdiness. People also

felt that Sony was more technologically advanced, more responsive to consumer needs, and also a tad more stylish.

When it came to satisfying customers, owners of PMPs felt that Apple products were of a better quality than Sony. People also voted that information about Apple's players was a lot more easy to get, but salesmen knew more about Sony products. Philips was considered to have the



It's the ultimate music player and world leader in this department. The iPod is just perfect.

Raghav Gupta, Udaipur

best after sales service, and had the best turnaround time for repairs. Apple was regarded as the brand to make all their models most easily available.

People were more inclined to talk positively about both Sony and Apple to others, but more people were keen on using Apple products over the coming years. Sony was way ahead when we asked the respondents whether they would buy products of different categories.

When it came to cost of ownership, Philips, Creative and Transcend won the top three spots, with Apple and Sony at sixth and fourth respectively.

All the buzz around Apple's products has earned it this award simply because most people think Apple (or iPod) when they think of PMPs. This was by far the hardest category to call, with the smallest margin of victory.